

THE TONY CUTS — EXPLAINED IN PLAIN ENGLISH

What we're shooting at Tony's pool site and why

Read this once before the shoot.

Why Tony's testimonial shoot is separate from Victor's

Victor (VIP General Contractor) just signed with Scale SD. He has no measurable results yet. So at Victor's shoot we shoot Peter solo cuts + a Victor "day 1" intro. No fake testimonials.

Tony (World Pools Inc) has been a client long enough that we have **real numbers** — busy calendar, real revenue, "too busy to count" verbatim. Testimonials require something to testify to. So Tony gets his own dedicated shoot at his actual pool site.

In edit, we combine both shoots into 6-7 final launch ads.

Audience rule (still applies)

The AUDIENCE we call out in copy is **"high-ticket San Diego home service contractors"** broadly — GCs, HVAC, roofers, plumbers, remodelers, hardscape, pools.

We don't single out a single trade. Why: per Fathom strategy lock, Scale SD doesn't compete with same-trade competitors of existing clients. Calling out "pool builders" would target Tony's competitors. So Tony's pool site is the visual proof, but the copy stays generic-trade.

A roofer watching this thinks: "if it works for that contractor, it works for me."

The 5 cuts at Tony's shoot

CUT 1 — "Too Busy to Count"

What it is: A short conversation between Peter and Tony. About 15-20 seconds in the final ad.

What we do: Peter asks Tony how many leads we sent him last month. Tony hedges and downplays — "honestly bro, I lost count, a lot." Peter looks at his phone and gives the actual number. Tony says "Yeah, I'd have to look. We've been swamped." Peter turns to camera and says: "See, this guy's too busy with jobs to count the leads. That's a good thing."

Why we shoot it: Cesar (Spark Marketing) has been running this exact format for 145 days as his #1 ad. Why it works: the fact that Tony doesn't remember the numbers makes him sound REAL, not like he's reading a script. Peter being the one who pulls receipts (the texts on his phone) makes Scale SD look like the ones doing the work, not just talking about it.

What people watching this ad will think: "This contractor is so busy he can't even keep track. I want to be too busy. How do I get to that?"

(Note: viewers see Tony at a pool site but Peter says "this guy" generically. Other-trade contractors read it as "if it works for him, it works for me.")

CUT 2 — "How Long, How Much"

What it is: Another conversation between Peter and Tony. 20-30 seconds.

What we do: Peter asks: how long have we been working together, how's the calendar now, and how much new revenue. Tony hedges (downplays) the numbers — "a few jobs," "I'd have to check the books." Peter looks at his phone and gives a real figure. Tony says "Either way I'm not complaining."

Why we shoot it: Same conversational format as Cut 1, but it specifically pulls a revenue number from Tony's pipeline. Same proof of busy-ness, but with dollar signal. We can use this to target contractors who care about the financial outcome, not just the calendar.

What people watching this ad will think: "He's making more money. The math works. I want that."

IMPORTANT: Don't say a specific dollar figure on camera unless Dani and Ashen can verify it from records. If Tony doesn't know exactly, his "Either way I'm not complaining" line is the safety phrase. We can edit around the number.

CUT 3 — "Phone Before / Phone Now"

What it is: A third conversation. 15-25 seconds. Same format, different angle.

What we do: Peter asks what the phone was like BEFORE Scale SD. Tony answers (slow, off-season pain, referrals only, tire-kickers). Peter asks what was Tony doing to fill it (hoping spring would save the year). Peter asks what the phone is like NOW (booked, picking which jobs to take). Then Peter turns to camera and says: "That's what it looks like when the phone works for a contractor. If you want the same thing for your business, link's below."

Why we shoot it: This is the "before vs after" version. It paints a picture of pain (phone slow, hustling for referrals, off-season fear) and then shows the relief. Powerful because every high-ticket contractor watching has the SAME pain. Tony's just farther down the road than they are.

What people watching this ad will think: "That's exactly what my phone looks like right now. He fixed it. How?"

CUT 4 — "Summer Locked Up"

What it is: Tony talking alone to the camera, no Peter. 15-20 seconds in the final ad.

What we do: Peter says off-camera: "Just tell the camera, in your own words, why any contractor in 2026 needs marketing. Don't sell us. Speak generally — to GCs, HVAC guys, roofers, not just guys in your trade." Then Tony talks for 30-45 seconds in his own words. We pull the strongest 15-20 seconds in edit.

Why we shoot it: This is the contractor-to-contractor version. No Peter, no Scale SD pitch. Just Tony speaking peer-to-peer. We want him to hit ideas like: - Home service work is feast-or-famine. Summer IS the year. - Referrals don't fire when you need them most. - If March is slow, you're cooked for July. - Once Scale SD started running ads, I locked up summer by April.

But not because he's reading them — because he means them. Coach him to address other trades, not just his own. "Contractors like me" not "pool builders like me."

What people watching this ad will think: "This is just another contractor like me telling me what he learned. Not an agency selling me. I trust this."

Coaching for Tony: Casual profanity is fine if natural. Spark's clients use it. Reads as real. Just talk like you would to another contractor at a barbecue.

CUT 10 — "Tony Tagline Tag"

What it is: NOT a finished ad. It's a 5-second ENDING that we paste onto OTHER ads in editing.

What we do: Tony stands at the pool, looks at the camera, and says one of three lines (we'll pick best in edit):

- **A:** "World Pools builds. Scale SD markets. That's how summer locks up."
- **B:** "I build the pool. Scale SD fills the calendar. Easy."
- **C:** "World Pools Inc. Real builds. Real ads. Real summer."

We shoot each version twice. 6 takes total.

If Tony has his own brand tagline: Use that. Pool builders sometimes have catchphrases. If he has one he likes, that's the most credible version.

Why we shoot it: A 5-second closing line in Tony's voice gives every ad we make for the next 6+ months a credibility-transfer ending. The audience hears HIS voice connected to Scale SD.

How we use it after the shoot: In editing, we paste this 5-second ending onto: - Cut 1 (Too Busy to Count) → Tony's tagline as the closing - Cut 7 from Victor shoot (Burned Bob Confession) → Same Tony tagline - Cut 8 from Victor shoot (Walkthrough) → Same Tony tagline - Static ad → Static frame of Tony with his tagline as text

So we shoot the 5-second tag ONCE and it appears in 4-5 different ads.

Why this is high-leverage: 6 takes. 10 minutes of shooting. Adds a credibility-transfer ending to every other ad we make for 6+ months.

How Tony's cuts combine with Victor's cuts at Friday launch

Final ad	Built from	Source shoot
Picking Jobs (15s, anchor)	Tony Cut 1 + Cut 10 ending	Tony
Summer Window (30s)	Cut 6 + b-roll	Victor (today)
Burned Bob Confession (45s)	Cut 7 + Tony b-roll	Victor (today) + Tony
Phone Before/Now (30s)	Tony Cut 3 + Cut 4 b-roll	Tony
5-Second Teaser (5s)	Cut 5 + Hook from Cut 9	Victor (today)
Static Ad (n/a)	Tad designs from b-roll stills	Victor + Tony
Day-1 Documentary (30s, BONUS)	Cut V + Cut 8 walkthrough	Victor (today)

3 ads from Tony's shoot. 4 ads from Victor's shoot. 1 combined ad.

Together: 6-7 final launch ads.

The simple version of all 5 Tony cuts

Cut	One sentence
1	Conversation: Peter asks how many leads, Tony doesn't remember, Peter pulls phone for receipts.
2	Conversation: Peter asks how much revenue, Tony lowballs, Peter pulls phone for the real number.
3	Conversation: Phone before vs phone now. Pain to relief.
4	Tony alone, talking to camera in his own words, contractor-to-contractor.
10	Tony's brand tagline as a 5-second ending we paste onto multiple ads (building block).

Why Tony's shoot matters strategically

- 1. Real testimonials are non-negotiable.** Spark Marketing's longest-running ads are testimonial-format. Manus AI confirmed it. We need ours.

2. **Tony's verbatim "too busy to count" line is gold.** It's the kind of phrase that no scriptwriter could invent — it has to come from a real client.
 3. **Pool sites are visually richer than bathroom remodels.** Water, scale, hardscape, equipment. Better b-roll across the whole library.
 4. **Tony has been a client long enough to be credible.** He's not a 1-week customer. The numbers are real.
 5. **Sets up perpetual content engine.** Same format works for every future client at month 3+. Today's Victor footage will become next quarter's Tony equivalent.
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What needs to happen between Victor shoot and Tony shoot

1. **Schedule:** Dani contacts Tony, locks date within 7 days
 2. **Confirm Tony's site stage:** must have visible work in progress
 3. **Confirm Tony's brand tagline** (if any) or commit to using one of the 3 substitutes
 4. **Pull lead-count and revenue numbers** for Tony from GHL — Peter needs them on his phone for Cut 1 + Cut 2 fact-check moments
 5. **Verify what dollar figures we can claim on camera** with Dani's written approval
 6. **Audio plan:** outdoor pool site = wind. Foam lav covers, monitoring on headphones every setup.
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Print this. Read it once before the Tony shoot. Bring the TONY-SHOOTING-SCRIPTS document to set. Last updated: 2026-05-06.